MA ENGLISH • SEMESTER 1

Block 2 — Unit 1: Teaching LSRW Skills

ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING • M21EG01AC

Expanded exam notes | Simple teaching + developed argument

Based on the supplied SGOU self-learning material. Use the assigned primary texts for exact quotations and full scene or passage analysis.

The chapter in one sentence

Listening, speaking, reading, and writing develop through purposeful tasks, explicit support, feedback, and repeated opportunities to use the skills together.

Start with a picture

Planning a class visit may require hearing an announcement, discussing choices, reading a timetable, and writing a message. Real communication often connects skills that a textbook separates for teaching convenience.

1. Listening: construct meaning, not catch every word

Listening involves recognising sound patterns, connecting words, using context, and revising an interpretation. **Bottom-up** processing works from sounds and words; **top-down** processing uses expectations and knowledge. Effective listening draws on both.

A teaching sequence

Before listening, establish a purpose and activate relevant knowledge. During the first encounter, ask for a manageable overall meaning. On another listening, focus on selected details. Afterwards, compare evidence, clarify a difficult part, and use the information in a response.

Different accents, speeds, recording quality, vocabulary, and anxiety can create different difficulties. Avoid diagnosing all difficulty as poor attention. Use replay, a transcript at an appropriate stage, clearer task instructions, or targeted sound work according to the problem.

A transcript should support learning rather than automatically replace listening.
Native-speaker recordings are not the only authentic English models; relevant intelligible varieties matter.

2. Speaking: purposeful interaction

Speaking requires planning, vocabulary retrieval, pronunciation, grammatical choices, turn-taking, and response to another person. An accurate rehearsed monologue does not measure every part of interaction.

A teaching sequence

Model a relevant exchange. Let learners plan ideas and useful phrases. Use pairs or small groups to reduce the pressure of immediate public performance. Give a task with a reason to exchange meanings. Provide feedback, then repeat with a changed partner or new information.

Fluency concerns the management of continuous communication; **accuracy** concerns appropriate control of forms. Neither should be the only goal. Intelligibility is generally more useful than insisting on imitation of one accent.

Responding to difficulty

Limited vocabulary may call for a phrase bank; fear of judgement may call for rehearsal and safer participation; a recurring pronunciation issue may need focused listening and practice. Do not interrupt every fluency task for every error. Record patterns and select feedback relevant to the objective.

3. Reading: purpose directs strategy

Skimming seeks a general overview; **scanning** locates a specific item. Close reading examines language, structure, implication, and evidence. Extensive reading provides sustained encounters with accessible texts.

A reader needs decoding, vocabulary, sentence knowledge, background understanding, and inference. A slow reader may face different difficulties at each level.

A teaching sequence

State a purpose, preview relevant features, read for gist, locate or infer selected information, then evaluate or use it. Ask learners which part of the text supports an answer. Guessing vocabulary from context is useful when evidence is sufficient, not an instruction to invent a meaning without clues.

Help learners distinguish a text’s explicit statement from an inference and an unsupported assumption. Difficult literature may require contextual or linguistic scaffolding before independent analysis.

4. Writing: a recursive process

Writing usually involves planning, drafting, revising meaning and organisation, editing language, and sharing. The stages can recur rather than follow one unbreakable order.

Coherence concerns the overall intelligibility and organisation of ideas. **Cohesion** concerns the linguistic links among parts. Many connecting words do not automatically produce a coherent argument.

A teaching sequence

Give a clear audience and purpose. Study a model, identify its useful features, plan an outline, draft, receive focused feedback, revise, and edit. A message to a classmate and a formal complaint need different choices.

Feedback should prioritise. If ideas are unclear, marking every spelling error alone will not solve the problem. Give an actionable next step, such as moving the reason before the request or clarifying who a pronoun refers to.

5. An integrated lesson example

For a group planning a library visit:

1. Listen to a short announcement and identify opening arrangements.
2. Read a timetable and accessibility information.
3. Discuss a suitable time using different group constraints.
4. Write a concise message confirming the plan and asking one necessary question.
5. Review whether the message lets its audience act correctly.

The example is a teaching design, not a quoted activity from the textbook. Adapt its language level, materials, and support to the learners.

6. Assess skills with relevant evidence

A multiple-choice grammar test cannot by itself establish speaking interaction. Observe a performance aligned with the objective. A short rubric might distinguish task completion, intelligibility or organisation, relevant language control, and the use of clarification or revision.

Collect more than one sample where an important judgement is needed. A single nervous performance is limited evidence of general ability.

7. Access and motivation

Offer readable layouts, captions or transcripts where appropriate, planning time, alternative modes of participation, and manageable task demands. Support should respond to observed needs rather than fixed labels such as visual learner. The aim is participation with meaningful challenge, not automatic reduction of expectations.

Quick check

1. Does good listening mean recognising every word? **No; purpose matters.**
2. Are cohesion and coherence identical? **No.**
3. Can one grammar worksheet assess all four skills? **No.**
4. Why repeat a task? **It gives learners a chance to apply feedback with less processing pressure.**

Build an exam answer

1. State the learners, purpose, and outcome.
2. Connect the four skills through necessary information.

3. Provide staged and adjustable support.
4. Diagnose different causes of difficulty.
5. Use an aligned rubric, feedback, and another performance.

Common mistake to avoid

Do not equate language ability with accent imitation, treat all errors alike, or claim integration merely because four unrelated worksheets appear in one lesson.

Developed exam discussion

Practice question

Design an integrated LSRW lesson and explain how you would diagnose difficulties and assess progress.

Explain the argument in fuller paragraphs

An integrated lesson should connect the four skills through a meaningful purpose rather than merely include one exercise of each type. Planning a visit gives learners a reason to listen to an announcement, read practical information, discuss constraints, and write a confirmation. The outcome provides a basis for selecting language and assessing whether communication succeeded.

Preparation makes the task accessible. The teacher activates relevant knowledge, previews essential vocabulary, and models a useful exchange or message. During the task, learners work with manageable information gaps and an audience that needs the result. Such support should be adjustable: a phrase bank may be necessary initially and removable when independence grows.

Observation helps distinguish difficulties. A learner who misses a detail because of connected speech needs a different response from one who understood the recording but misunderstood the question. Similarly, a hesitant speaker may know the grammar yet need planning time or practice retrieving phrases. A writer’s weak organisation cannot be repaired by spelling correction alone. Feedback should identify the relevant mechanism and offer another attempt.

Assessment must match the objective. A rubric can separate completion of the plan, clarity of the message, relevant language control, and interactive strategies. Several samples and opportunities to revise provide a more credible picture than one isolated score. The evidence then informs the next lesson, completing the link between teaching, observation, and improvement.

Use the discussion well

Answer the exact question, not every possible topic. Make one clear point per paragraph, support it with a textual detail or a relevant classroom example, and explain its significance. Check exact quotations against the assigned text. The discussion is paraphrase and guidance, not a quotation or a guaranteed exam answer.

Textbook assignment checklist

The following numbered prompts are retained from the unit for revision. Obvious source errors are discussed in the coverage review; a prompt’s assumptions should not be accepted automatically. These are not predictions or complete written assignments.

1. What are LSRW skills, and why are they essential for language learning? Explain how LSRW skills are interconnected and necessary for effective communication.
2. Discuss the different methods and techniques that can be used to teach listening skills in an English classroom. Give examples of activities that can be incorporated into teaching listening skills.
3. What are the different methods and techniques that can be used to teach speaking skills in an English classroom? Give examples of activities that can be incorporated into teaching speaking skills.
4. What are the language learners’ common challenges in developing specific language skills? Discuss the strategies that can be implemented to overcome them.
5. What are the listening and speaking skills essential for effective communication? Discuss each skill and provide examples of how they can be developed.